Korea 2026 Family Trip Itinerary

April 23 – May 4, 2026 | Eran, Michal, Jonathan & Ofir

Route: Seoul (3 nights) → Jeju (3 nights) → Busan (2 nights) → Seoul (3 nights)

Day 1 — Apr 23 (Thu) | Arrive Seoul

- **10:50** Land at Incheon Airport. Pick up eSIMs, T-money cards
- AREX or taxi to hotel (~1 hr)
- **Late PM:** Walk around **Myeongdong** — people-watching, street food
- **Dinner: Yukjeon Hoekwan** — Michelin-listed bulgogi since 1966
- **Evening:** Stroll **Cheonggyecheon Stream** (lit up at night)

Hotel: Amid Hotel Seoul · Jongno/Insadong 🌧️ **Rain plan:** Myeongdong and Cheonggyecheon work fine in light rain. If heavy, underground shopping at Myeongdong Station or relax at hotel.

Day 2 — Apr 24 (Fri) | Seoul Culture

- **Morning: Naksan Park** — city views
- **AM: Ihwa Mural Village** — street art
- **Lunch: Ssamjigil** — Insadong crafts + street food lunch
- **PM:** 🐱 **Themed Cafe** — Poop Cafe or animal cafe (Insadong)
- **PM: Jogyesa Temple** — lotus lanterns
- **PM: Seochon** — cafes, galleries
- **PM:** 🏛️ **Deoksugung Palace** — stone wall walk (on the way south)
- **Evening:** 💆 **Abijou Clinic** — Korean Aqua Peel facial
- **Dinner: Maple Tree House** (Samcheong-dong) — Korean BBQ
- **Night option:** ✨ **DDP at night** — Zaha Hadid landmark + LED rose garden

Hotel: Amid Hotel Seoul · Jongno/Insadong 🌧️ **Rain plan:** National Museum of Korea (free, world-class), COEX Mall underground, or Lotte World indoor theme park.

Day 3 — Apr 25 (Sat) | Suwon + Tower + Jungsik

- **8:30 AM:** 🏯 Train to **Suwon Hwaseong Fortress** wall walk (5.7 km, UNESCO)
- **10:30 AM: Haenggung Palace** — martial arts + guard performances (weekends)
- **11:00 AM: Haenggung Street** — busking, crafts, galleries, street food
- **12:00 PM:** 🍗 **Suwon Chicken Street** — famous Korean fried chicken
- **2:00 PM: Namdaemun Market** — walk at your own pace
- **5:30 PM: N Seoul Tower** — cable car up, sunset at 7:10 PM
- **7:15 PM:** 📚 **Starfield Library COEX** — iconic bookshelves (optional)
- **8:00 PM: Jungsik** — Michelin-starred modern Korean (splurge night)

Hotel: Amid Hotel Seoul · Jongno/Insadong **Transport:** 🚅 Seoul Station → Suwon (30 min train). Return same way after lunch. 🌧️ **Rain plan:** Skip Suwon fortress wall. Instead: War Memorial of Korea (free, indoor), Namdaemun Market (covered), then N Seoul Tower + Jungsik as planned.

Day 4 — Apr 26 (Sun) | Fly to Jeju

- **Morning:** Jeju Airport — pick up Alamo rental car
- **Optional:** 😊 Jeju Loveland — quirky sculpture park (~30 min)
- **PM — Pick one hike:**
  - 🥾 **Option A: Saryeoni Forest Trail** (flat, relaxing) | 10 km · 2–3 hrs · +222m

    - 🥾 **Option B: Hallasan — Eoseungsaengak Trail** | 2.1 km · 1–1.5 hrs · +190m
- **Optional afternoon activities (especially with Option B):**
    - 🌋 **Manjanggul Lava Tube** — UNESCO volcanic cave (~40 min)
    - 🐱 **Jeju Maze Park** — hedge maze, mini-golf, cats (~1 hr)
    - 🏘️ **Jeju Folk Village Museum** — 100+ traditional buildings (~1.5 hrs)
    - 🌺 **Hallim Park** — 9 themed gardens + lava caves (~1.5 hrs)
- **Dinner: Dombedon** — Michelin-rated Jeju black pork BBQ
- **Evening:** 🌙 **Jeju Dongmun Market** — evening food market (near hotel)

Hotel: Grabel Hotel Jeju · Jeju City **Transport:** ✈️ Gimpo → Jeju (~1 hr) + 🚙 Alamo rental car 🌧️ **Rain plan:** Saryeoni is beautiful in light rain (misty). If heavy: Jeju Folk Village Museum or Nexon Computer Museum.

Day 5 — Apr 27 (Mon) | Jeju E-Bike + Peak

- **8:00 AM: Seongsan Port** — early ferry to Udo Island (bring passport!)
- **8:30 AM:** 🚴 **E-bike Udo Island** — rent at Cheonjin Port | 15 km · 1.5–2 hrs · ~100m
- **~12:00 PM:** 🥾 **Seongsan Ilchulbong** (Sunrise Peak, after ferry back) | 1.8 km · 40–60 min · +142m

Hotel: Grabel Hotel Jeju 🌧️ **Rain plan:** Skip Udo (ferry may cancel). Instead: Manjanggul Lava Tube (underground, rain-proof) + Jeju Stone Park. Ilchulbong is fine in light rain.

Day 6 — Apr 28 (Tue) | Jeju Coastal Day

- **Morning:** 🥾 **Olle Trail Section 7** (start at Oedolgae) | 17.6 km full / 8–10 km partial · +288m
- **Midday:** 🌊 **Jeongbang Waterfall** — falls into the sea (20 min stop)
- **PM: Jusangjeolli Cliff** — basalt columns
- **PM: O'sulloc Tea Museum** + green tea fields
- **PM: Hyeopjae Beach**

Hotel: Grabel Hotel Jeju **Transport:** 🚙 Alamo rental car — last day driving. Return at Jeju Airport tomorrow morning. 🌧️ **Rain plan:** Skip Olle Trail. Keep Jusangjeolli (quick with umbrella), O'sulloc (indoor), add Spirited Garden or Jeju Glass Castle.

Day 7 — Apr 29 (Wed) | Fly to Busan

- **Morning:** Return car at Jeju Airport + fly to Busan (~50 min)
- **PM: Gamcheon Culture Village** — colorful hillside art village
- **PM: Haeundae Beach** walk
- **Dinner: Amsogalbi-jip** — premium beef galbi
- **Evening:** 🏮 **Samgwangsa Temple** — 40,000 lotus lanterns (Buddha's Birthday season)

Hotel: L7 Haeundae by Lotte · Haeundae, Busan 🌧️ **Rain plan:** Gamcheon has covered alleys — works in rain. If heavy: Busan Museum of Art or Shinsegae Centum City.

Day 8 — Apr 30 (Thu) | Busan + Gyeongju

- **9:15 AM: Yonggungsa Temple** — seaside (45 min)
- **11:30 AM: Bulguksa Temple** (UNESCO) — Gyeongju
- **1:30 PM:** 🥾 **Seokguram Grotto** — forest walk | 3 km · 1–1.5 hrs · +382m
- **5:30 PM: Hwangridan-gil** — dinner
- **6:30 PM:** 🗿 **Daereungwon Tomb Complex** — Silla royal burial mounds + Chomseongdae Observatory
- **7:15 PM: Wolji Pond** — night reflections (after sunset)

Hotel: L7 Haeundae by Lotte **Transport:** 🚕 Taxi to Yonggungsa (15 min) + private driver Yonggungsa → Gyeongju → back to Busan (~8 hrs) 🌧️ **Rain plan:** Temples are atmospheric in rain. If heavy all day: Busan Spa Land (jjimjilbang in Centum City) + Museum 1 (immersive LED art).

Day 9 — May 1 (Fri) | KTX to Seoul

- **9:00 AM: Blueline Park** — sky capsule (Mipo → Cheongsapo), taxi back
- **AM: Jagalchi Market**
- **AM: BIFF Square** — street food
- **Lunch: Gukje Market** — milmyeon (cold noodles)
- **PM: 🚅 KTX from Busan Station** → Seoul (2.5 hrs)
- **Dinner: Hongdae** — nightlife & dinner

Hotel: Shilla Stay Mapo Hongdae · Mapo, Seoul 🌧️ **Rain plan:** Markets and Blueline work in light rain. If heavy: skip Blueline, more time at covered markets, then KTX as planned.

Day 10 — May 2 (Sat) | Hike OR Icheon — Pick One

- **Morning — Pick one:**
  - 🥾 **Option A: Bukhansan — Bukhansanseong** (hard) | 6.8 km · 3–4 hrs · +500m
  - 🥾 **Option B: Inwangsan Fortress Wall** (moderate) | 3.5 km · 1.5–2 hrs · +236m
  - 🏺 **Option C: Icheon Ceramic Festival**
- **Evening:** 🎮 **PC Bang** — Korean gaming cafe in Hongdae
- **Late Night:** 🏪 Convenience store ramyeon + banana milk at GS25
- **Night option:** 🛍️ **Dongdaemun Night Shopping** (open until 5 AM)

Hotel: Shilla Stay Mapo Hongdae 🌧️ **Rain plan:** Skip hikes (dangerous when wet). Instead: Icheon Ceramic Festival, Lotte World indoor theme park, Korean cooking class, or Leeum Samsung Museum of Art.

Day 11 — May 3 (Sun) | DMZ + Palace + Farewell

- **Morning:** 🪖 **DMZ Tour** — half day
- **PM: Gyeongbokgung Palace**
- **PM: Bukchon Hanok Village**
- **Late PM: Gwangjang Market** — street food
- **Evening:** 🎭 **Optional: NANTA Show** — Myeongdong or Hongdae (~90 min)
- **Evening: Han River** — chimaek & farewell sunset

Hotel: Shilla Stay Mapo Hongdae 🌧️ **Rain plan:** DMZ runs rain or shine. Afternoon: National Museum of Korea (free), Dongdaemun shopping malls, or jjimjilbang (Dragon Hill Spa).

Day 12 — May 4 (Mon) | Depart

- Sleep in, pack, last brunch near hotel
- **~14:00** Head to Incheon (AREX or taxi, ~1 hr)
- **17:50** Flight home

Activity Summary

Hikes

Day	Trail	Distance	Time	Elevation
3	Suwon Hwaseong Fortress (Seoul)	5.7 km	2–3 hrs	Easy
4	Option A: Saryeoni Forest (Jeju)	10 km	2–3 hrs	+222m
4	Option B: Hallasan Eoseungsaengak (Jeju)	2.1 km	1–1.5 hrs	+190m
5	Seongsan Ilchulbong (Jeju)	1.8 km	40–60 min	+142m

6	Olle Trail Section 7 (Jeju)	17.6 km / partial	5–6 hrs	+288m
8	Seokguram Grotto (Gyeongju)	3 km	1–1.5 hrs	+382m
10	Option A: Bukhansan (Seoul)	6.8 km	3–4 hrs	+500m
10	Option B: Inwangsan (Seoul)	3.5 km	1.5–2 hrs	+236m

E-Bike Rides

Day	Route	Distance	Time	Terrain
5	Udo Island loop (Jeju)	15 km	1.5–2 hrs	Gentle rolling, ~100m

Hotels

Dates	Hotel	Location
Apr 23–26	Amid Hotel Seoul	Jongno/Insadong, Seoul
Apr 26–29	Grabel Hotel Jeju	Jeju City
Apr 29 – May 1	L7 Haeundae by Lotte	Haeundae, Busan
May 1–4	Shilla Stay Mapo Hongdae	Mapo, Seoul

Transport Summary

Segment	Nights	Transport	Car needed?
Seoul	3	AREX from airport	No — subway/taxi
Jeju	3	Flight from Gimpo	Yes — Alamo rental car
Busan	2	Flight from Jeju	No — taxi + private driver for Gyeongju
Seoul	3	KTX from Busan	No — subway/taxi

🍜 Korean Food Checklist

- [ ] Bibimbap (비빔밥)
- [ ] Korean BBQ — Samgyeopsal / Galbi (삼겹살 / 갈비)
- [ ] Tteokbokki (떡볶이)
- [ ] Japchae (잡채)
- [ ] Sundubu-jjigae (순두부찌개)
- [ ] Kimbap (김밥)
- [ ] Jjajangmyeon (짜장면)
- [ ] Chimaek — Fried Chicken + Beer (치맥)
- [ ] Hotteok (호떡)
- [ ] Milmyeon (밀면)

Updated April 2026 | Korea Trip Companion App